

Spiritual Gems — Week of June 29 – July 5, 2026

Bible reading: Jeremiah 11-12

"What spiritual gems from this week's Bible reading would you like to share?"

15 options + 2 research/insight angles (highlighted in blue). Each ~20–30 sec spoken (≈ 55–75 words). Avoids the Treasures verses (Jer 11:21; 12:5) and the official Insight question (Jer 12:1, 3).

#	Verse	What I take away
1	Jer 11:4	Obedience is what keeps us close to Jehovah, not what earns his closeness
2	Jer 11:5	Jeremiah's "Amen" — the messenger who genuinely agrees with the message
3	Jer 11:7	Jehovah warned "again and again" — the pattern for our own persistence
4	Jer 11:8	The biggest obstacle to spiritual growth is usually inside us
5	Jer 11:16	Jehovah remembers what he planted us to become
6	Jer 11:17	"Your Planter" — a rare and beautiful title for Jehovah
7	Jer 11:18	Jehovah doesn't leave his loyal ones blindsided
8	Jer 11:20	Jehovah examines our <i>innermost</i> thoughts — frightening and beautiful
9	Jer 12:2	"On their lips, but far from their innermost thoughts" — no lip service
10	Jer 12:6	Family opposition puts us on Jeremiah's — and Jesus' — path
11	Jer 12:7	Judgment doesn't cancel Jehovah's affection — it comes from it
12	Jer 12:10	Jehovah notices what leaders do to his people
13	Jer 12:11	Spiritual numbness is possible — help people feel again
14	Jer 12:13	Only what we sow for Jehovah reaps something worth keeping
15	Jer 12:16	The door has always been open to outsiders
R1	Jer 11:19	Research <i>Insight book:</i> the docile lamb foreshadowed Christ
R2	Jer 11:4	Research <i>Insight book:</i> what "iron-smelting furnace" reveals about Egypt's oppression

1 • Jeremiah 11:4

*"Obey my voice, and do all the things that I command you; and **you will become my people and I will be your God.**"*

What I love about Jer 11:4 is Jehovah's original offer. When he brought Israel out of Egypt, he didn't hand them a book of rules — he offered them a relationship. *Obey my voice, and you will become my people and I will be your God.* That's still the offer today. Obedience isn't the price of being close to Jehovah — it's what keeps us close to him.

2 • Jeremiah 11:5

*"And I answered: '**Amen**, O Jehovah.'"*

After Jehovah reminds Israel of his oath, Jeremiah responds with one word: *"Amen."* That little word in Jer 11:5 shows me his heart. He's not a reluctant messenger. He's in agreement. *Yes, Jehovah. So let it be.* In the ministry, that same *"Amen"* has to be in me — genuine agreement with what I'm delivering, not just recitation.

3 • Jeremiah 11:7

*"I solemnly admonished your forefathers... admonishing them **again and again**: 'Obey my voice.'"*

Jer 11:7 says Jehovah *solemnly admonished* their forefathers — *"again and again"* — from the day he brought them out of Egypt through the generations. What a picture of Jehovah's patience. He didn't warn once and give up. That's the standard for our own ministry. If the Master keeps knocking, the servant doesn't stop knocking either.

4 • Jeremiah 11:8

*"But they did not listen or incline their ear; instead, each kept **stubbornly following his own wicked heart**."*

Jer 11:8 gives us the cause: they *"stubbornly followed their own wicked heart."* Not that they lacked information. Not that they hadn't been warned. They just wouldn't leave their own heart's counsel. It reminds me that the biggest obstacle to my spiritual growth usually isn't out there in the world. It's inside me. Which voice am I following today?

5 • Jeremiah 11:16

*"Jehovah once called you a **thriving olive tree**, beautiful with fine fruit..."*

In Jer 11:16, Jehovah looks at his people and calls them *"a thriving olive tree, beautiful with fine fruit."* That's how he had *seen* them. Even as he warned of judgment, he was still remembering what they could be. It tells me Jehovah's eye is never coldly fixed on our failures. He remembers what he planted us to become — and that's what draws him to keep helping us.

6 • Jeremiah 11:17

*"Jehovah of armies, **your Planter**, has declared..."*

One phrase in Jer 11:17 caught me: Jehovah is called *"your Planter."* Not our judge, not our king in this line — our **Planter**. Someone who put us in the ground with a purpose, watered us, protected us so we could grow. In the ministry, we're not selling people something new. We're pointing them back to the One who planted them in the first place.

7 • Jeremiah 11:18

*"Jehovah **informed me** so that I would know; At that time you caused me to see what they were doing."*

Jer 11:18 has an easily-missed line: *"Jehovah informed me so that I would know."* A plot was forming against Jeremiah — from his own townspeople — and Jehovah warned him in advance. What a Father. He doesn't leave his loyal ones blindsided. That's why we stay close to him — not so nothing bad ever happens, but so nothing catches us alone.

8 • Jeremiah 11:20

*"Jehovah of armies... examines the **innermost thoughts and the heart**."*

Jer 11:20 gives us one of the boldest descriptions of Jehovah in the Bible: he *"examines the innermost thoughts and the heart."* Not our words. Not our outward acts. Our *innermost* thoughts. On one hand, that's frightening. On the other — it's the most beautiful thing. It means Jehovah truly *knows* me. Even when I struggle to explain myself, he sees clearly.

9 • Jeremiah 12:2

*"You are on their **lips**, but far away from their **innermost thoughts**."*

Jer 12:2 draws the sharpest line: *"You are on their lips, but far away from their innermost thoughts."* Jehovah isn't fooled by talk. What he wants is his name in the *inner* room, not the front porch. It's a good self-check for me. Does Jehovah live in my thoughts when no one is listening? Or only in my prayers when someone might be?

10 • Jeremiah 12:6

*"Even your own brothers, the household of your own father, have **dealt treacherously** with you."*

Jer 12:6 is one of the harder verses in Jeremiah: *"Even your own brothers... have dealt treacherously with you."* Jeremiah's *family* opposed him. It's a lonely picture. But it also comforts me. When our own relatives push back on the truth, we're not walking a strange path. We're walking Jeremiah's path. And ultimately, Jesus' path too.

11 • Jeremiah 12:7

*"I have abandoned my house... I have given my **dearly beloved one** into the hand of her enemies."*

Jer 12:7 shows us a side of Jehovah we don't often think about. He says, *"I have given my dearly beloved one into the hand of her enemies."* **Dearly beloved.** Even as he releases her to consequences, that's still what he calls her. Judgment doesn't cancel his affection — it comes *from* it.

12 • Jeremiah 12:10

*"**Many shepherds** have destroyed my vineyard; They have trampled my portion of land."*

Jer 12:10 warns about *"many shepherds"* who destroyed Jehovah's vineyard. Bad leaders. Instead of feeding the flock, they trampled the land. What it tells me about Jehovah is how much he *notices*. He doesn't ignore what leaders do to his people. In the ministry, when we point to Jehovah's Kingdom, we're offering people a Shepherd who never tramples what he owns.

13 • Jeremiah 12:11

*"The whole land has been made desolate, but **no man takes it to heart**."*

Jer 12:11 says the land was made desolate *"but no man takes it to heart."* Devastation everywhere — and nobody was even *feeling* it. It reminds me that spiritual numbness is possible. In our territory, we meet people surrounded by bad news but no longer moved by it. Our job is to help them feel again — not by shocking them, but by showing them a real hope.

14 • Jeremiah 12:13

*"They have **sown wheat**, but they have **reaped thorns**. They have worn themselves out, but to no benefit."*

Jer 12:13 gives us a farmer's picture of the whole story: *"They have sown wheat, but they have reaped thorns. They have worn themselves out, but to no benefit."* All that effort. Nothing to show for it. It reminds me — the seeds we plant in this system don't yield a real harvest. Only what we sow for Jehovah reaps something worth keeping.

15 • Jeremiah 12:16

*"If they make sure to **learn the ways of my people** and to swear by my name... they will then be built up **among my people**."*

Jer 12:16 surprised me. Jehovah says if the surrounding nations *"learn the ways of my people"* and swear by *his* name, they will be *"built up among my people."* Even during a chapter of judgment, the door isn't closed to outsiders. It tells me the ministry has always mattered to Jehovah. His people were meant to be joined by others, not walled off from them.

Research**R1 · Jeremiah 11:19 — *Insight book connection***

"I was like a **docile lamb being brought to the slaughter...**"

Jer 11:19 says Jeremiah felt like "*a docile lamb being brought to the slaughter.*" What's remarkable — the *Insight on the Scriptures* connects this language to what Isaiah 53:7 says about the Messiah, and to how Jesus willingly went to his death. Jeremiah likely didn't know it, but his own experience was a shadow of Christ's. When we suffer for the truth, we're walking a very well-worn path.

Research**R2 · Jeremiah 11:4 — *Insight book on the "iron-smelting furnace"***

"...out of the land of Egypt, **out of the iron-smelting furnace...**"

Jer 11:4 mentions Jehovah bringing Israel out of "*the iron-smelting furnace*" of Egypt. According to the *Insight on the Scriptures*, this expression refers to the intense heat used to refine iron ore — a metaphor for Egypt's crushing, oppressive pressure on the Israelites. Jehovah didn't just rescue Israel from a country. He pulled them out of a furnace designed to break them. That's how vividly he pictures our own rescue from this world.